

Global EV/ESS Battery

Global/China EVB installed capacity +15%/+19% YoY; breakthrough in sodium-ion

Industry Overview

Global xEV sales -1% YoY in Mar'26; BEV outgrew hybrid

Global xEV sales were -1% YoY/+61% MoM in Mar. The YoY decline was mainly dragged by weak xEV sales in China (-22% YoY) and US (-24% YoY) due to dull demand, but witnessed a rebound from Feb'26 on a low base. The EU xEV sales were +38% YoY/+73% MoM due to surging fuel price in Mar'2026. Global BEV sales (+1% YoY) outgrew PHEVs (-6% YoY), with BEV penetration improving to 16.5% in Mar (vs. 13.5% in Feb'26).

Global EVB Mar installed capacity +15% YoY/+78% MoM

According to SNE Research, global EV battery installed capacity in Mar reached 109GWh, up 15% YoY/78% MoM. CATL's (+17% YoY) market share was 39%, ranking No.1 globally, followed by BYD (-3% YoY) with a share of 14%. LGES (+16% YoY) ranked No.3 with 11% share. By region, Europe outperformed the global market, with installed capacity +32% YoY in Mar, while US underperformed, -29% YoY. By form factor, prismatic comprised the most at 79%, vs. pouch/cylindrical at 11%/10% in Mar'26.

China EV battery installed capacity +19% YoY in March

According to RealLi, total China EV battery installed capacity (based on EVs produced in China, including exports) in March was 73GWh, up 19% YoY/84% MoM, in line with the EV sales growth pattern. Battery installed capacity by vehicle type in March: passenger BEV: 59%; passenger PHEV: 16%; E-bus (BEV+PHEV): 1%; and special vehicle (BEV+PHEV): 24%. By EV battery chemistry, in March, NCM/LFP share came in at 17%/83%. According to our supply chain check, CATL's planned production is estimated to be 102GWh in May, up 81% YoY/10% MoM, which looks robust to us.

LGES excels SDI/SK on solid EU EV; focus on ESS growth

Korea EV battery installed capacity was up 3% YoY in Mar'26. LGES outperformed the rest (+16% YoY vs SDI/SK's -28%/-6% YoY) on the back of solid shipments to EU (LGES: +31% YoY, vs SDI/SK's -2%/10% YoY, vs EU xEV sales +38% YoY), while K-battery's combined volume to the US remained weak (-45% YoY) amid lukewarm xEV demand (since IRA CVC repeal in 4Q25). We continue to see US ESS as K-battery's key growth driver in 2026 (LGES's ESS shipments 3x YoY; SDI ESS gaining momentum in 2H) as highlighted in our recent reports (see [LGES 1Q26 review](#), [SDI upgrade to Buy](#)).

Breakthrough in sodium-ion battery

On 21 April, CATL held 2026 Tech Day and unveiled a series of breakthrough battery technologies, including fast-charging batteries, condensed batteries, sodium-ion batteries, etc. (see report: [2026 Tech Day: fast-charging, condensed battery and sodium-ion battery](#)). According to CATL, the core challenges in the manufacturing process of its sodium-ion battery have been resolved, and the company expects mass production to begin in 4Q26. On 27 April, CATL signed a strategic cooperation agreement with HyperStrong to ship 60GWh sodium-ion battery over three years.

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NEV: New energy vehicle

EV: Electric vehicle

EVB: Electric vehicle battery

BEV: Battery electric vehicle

PHEV: Plugin-hybrid electric vehicle

GWh: Gigawatt hour

LFP: Lithium iron phosphate

Li: Lithium

NCM: Nickel, cobalt and manganese

LNy: Lunar new year

ESS: Energy storage systems

AIDC: Artificial intelligence data center

IRA: Inflation reduction act

CVC: Clean vehicle credit

Key tables and charts – Global battery

Exhibit 1: EV (PV + CV) sales by regions (unit)

Global EV sales down 1% YoY but up 61% MoM in Mar-2026

Region	Type	Apr-25	May-25	Jun-25	Jul-25	Aug-25	Sep-25	Oct-25	Nov-25	Dec-25	Jan-26	Feb-26	Mar-26	MoM	YoY
Europe	BEV	212,694	224,878	285,974	220,887	192,709	295,768	260,844	294,855	362,239	215,227	217,557	383,918	76%	40%
	PHEV	107,680	116,537	128,766	120,456	88,928	142,849	127,104	125,970	138,162	106,086	102,482	168,330	64%	32%
	FCV	20	63	419	78	4	2	1	2	0	5	8	2	-75%	-67%
	Total	320,394	341,478	415,159	341,421	281,641	438,619	387,949	420,827	500,401	321,318	320,047	552,250	73%	38%
China	BEV	676,287	731,955	829,562	757,877	836,183	993,004	907,345	925,522	976,138	435,395	341,039	607,315	78%	-21%
	PHEV	239,101	276,906	325,089	268,698	301,421	349,552	327,684	338,249	414,235	151,437	119,578	185,253	55%	-26%
	Total	915,388	1,008,861	1,154,651	1,026,575	1,137,604	1,342,556	1,235,029	1,263,771	1,390,373	586,832	460,617	792,568	72%	-22%
US	BEV	96,472	105,013	100,513	129,379	146,017	145,616	72,503	71,417	83,251	62,162	70,343	83,552	19%	-20%
	PHEV	38,608	32,727	23,937	29,970	34,559	29,737	16,457	16,744	19,877	12,345	14,472	24,710	71%	-35%
	FCV	25	20	25	40	41	70	38	29	37	33	27	37	38%	493%
	Total	135,105	137,760	124,475	159,389	180,617	175,423	88,998	88,190	103,165	74,540	84,843	108,299	28%	-24%
Global	BEV	1,094,078	1,196,255	1,353,322	1,238,604	1,314,740	1,597,174	1,391,805	1,436,397	1,605,177	871,382	779,873	1,275,921	64%	1%
	PHEV	415,034	458,227	514,863	456,496	458,611	560,164	507,900	516,537	612,102	310,608	273,649	423,194	55%	-6%
	FCV	388	240	747	1,257	2,528	3,593	2,796	1,984	1,955	1,516	2,095	2,773	32%	255%
	Total	1,509,500	1,654,722	1,868,932	1,696,357	1,775,879	2,160,930	1,902,501	1,954,917	2,219,234	1,183,506	1,055,617	1,701,888	61%	-1%

Source: S&P Research, BofA Global Research

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Exhibit 2: Battery installed capacity on car (PEV + CEV) by regions (MWh)

China battery installed capacity was up 8% YoY/101% MoM in Mar-2026

Region	Mar-25	Apr-25	May-25	Jun-25	Jul-25	Aug-25	Sep-25	Oct-25	Nov-25	Dec-25	Jan-26	Feb-26	Mar-26	MoM	YoY
Europe	22,105	17,175	17,932	22,229	17,780	15,084	23,475	20,377	22,615	27,767	16,559	16,567	29,262	76.6%	32.4%
China	53,154	51,136	56,125	62,587	56,506	62,925	74,472	71,481	77,299	87,009	39,212	28,680	57,558	100.7%	8.3%
US	11,315	10,235	10,972	10,049	12,143	14,892	16,550	6,436	5,966	7,761	6,260	6,194	8,010	29.3%	-29.2%
Global	94,924	85,614	93,499	104,001	94,930	101,864	124,734	109,022	115,441	133,602	71,911	61,206	109,087	78.2%	14.9%

Source: SNE Research, BofA Global Research

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Exhibit 3: Top-10 battery makers installed capacity on PEV & CEV (MWh)

CATL secured 39% global market share in Mar-2026

(MWh)	Mar-25	Apr-25	May-25	Jun-25	Jul-25	Aug-25	Sep-25	Oct-25	Nov-25	Dec-25	Jan-26	Feb-26	Mar-26	MoM	YoY
CATL	36,371	32,813	35,696	40,753	35,411	37,462	46,301	44,377	48,684	56,829	32,523	25,137	42,696	69.9%	17.4%
BYD	15,637	14,854	15,859	18,926	15,441	17,179	19,809	17,925	17,992	20,475	9,934	7,711	15,228	97.5%	-2.6%
LGES	10,144	7,292	8,644	10,315	9,247	9,961	13,400	7,003	8,741	11,984	4,743	6,877	11,786	71.4%	16.2%
CALB	3,824	4,178	4,643	4,972	5,485	5,799	6,325	7,189	6,974	8,245	3,785	2,525	5,349	111.8%	39.9%
Panasonic	4,736	4,772	5,120	5,100	4,721	5,783	7,657	3,519	3,127	4,386	3,090	2,248	3,346	48.8%	-29.3%
Gotion	3,270	3,875	3,827	3,777	4,048	4,645	5,817	6,111	6,624	6,679	2,805	2,188	4,901	124.0%	49.9%
SK On	4,135	3,265	3,436	3,589	4,330	4,431	5,377	3,131	3,113	3,757	2,312	2,901	3,884	33.9%	-6.1%
SVOLT	1,855	1,907	2,043	2,151	2,434	2,238	2,825	3,275	3,430	3,287	1,912	1,864	2,752	47.6%	48.4%
EVE	2,787	2,340	2,404	2,435	2,327	2,561	2,962	3,049	3,000	3,753	1,756	1,429	3,819	167.2%	37.0%
SDI	3,106	2,461	2,563	2,525	2,571	2,565	2,935	1,859	1,894	2,177	1,580	1,696	2,248	32.6%	-27.6%
Others	9,058	7,856	9,263	9,457	8,916	9,239	11,326	11,583	11,863	12,031	7,470	6,628	13,077	97.3%	44.4%
Grand Total	94,924	85,614	93,499	104,001	94,930	101,864	124,734	109,022	115,441	133,602	71,911	61,206	109,087	78.2%	14.9%

Source: SNE Research, BofA Global Research

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Exhibit 4: Battery (include EV, ESS, consumer electronics battery) production by top-5 suppliers in China

CATL's May planned production is 102GWh, +81% YoY/+10% MoM

(GWh)	May-25	Jun-25	Jul-25	Aug-25	Sep-25	Oct-25	Nov-25	Dec-25	Jan-26	Feb-26	Mar-26	Apr-26E	May-26E
CATL	56.5	58.6	61.8	64.5	70.5	73.5	75.0	77.5	75.5	67.0	82.0	92.5	102.0
BYD	24.3	22.3	21.4	23.4	24.8	26.0	27.0	27.0	24.8	21.2	26.0	26.6	27.4
EVE	7.6	8.4	8.4	9.8	10.4	11.9	12.2	12.2	12.2	10.8	13.1	13.3	15.0
CALB	9.6	9.1	8.9	9.3	10.7	12.5	13.0	13.2	12.4	9.5	12.8	13.7	13.8
Gotion	5.8	6.8	8.8	9.0	10.1	11.8	12.1	12.1	11.1	9.3	11.3	12.1	12.9
Industry *	142.0	143.5	154.8	164.9	180.9	194.9	199.6	203.8	195.2	165.4	208.4		

Source: ICCSino *We include selected EV battery suppliers

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Exhibit 5: China monthly BESS new installation (GWh)

China BESS new installation was up 148% YoY in 1Q26

	2023	2024	2025	2026
Jan	1.4	7.9	5.0	10.9
Feb	1.0	1.3	3.7	13.3
Mar	2.1	3.1	3.7	6.6
Apr	2.4	5.5	6.1	
May	1.3	4.8	26.0	
Jun	8.3	14.0	11.3	
Jul	4.9	11.9	8.7	
Aug	1.1	5.6	8.0	
Sep	1.6	3.0	9.2	
Oct	1.6	6.9	12.6	
Nov	7.2	12.1	11.2	
Dec	13.7	25.4	77.6	
Total	46.6	101.6	183.0	

Source: CNESA, BofA Global Research

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Exhibit 6: China monthly ESS battery shipment (GWh)

ESS battery shipment +95% YoY in 1Q26

	2023	2024	2025	2026
Jan	12.0	12.4	32.7	63.0
Feb	14.5	9.5	29.6	56.1
Mar	14.0	20.2	32.9	67.1
Apr	13.5	28.1	34.9	
May	16.4	29.9	36.6	
Jun	19.8	29.2	41.7	
Jul	19.8	29.1	44.2	
Aug	18.3	31.6	49.9	
Sep	16.1	35.6	52.7	
Oct	14.8	37.9	54.3	
Nov	12.9	42.5	57.5	
Dec	11.1	38.3	62.5	
Total	183.2	344.2	529.4	

Source: SMM, BofA Global Research

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